Kokanee Springs RV Village — Entrance Sign Construction Specifications

Project: Renovation of Existing Entrance Gateway Sign

Location: 53118 Highway 31, Seba Beach, Parkland County, Alberta

Date: February 12, 2026

Version: V4.3 Final

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1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

This specification covers the renovation and cladding of the existing timber entrance gateway at Kokanee Springs RV Village. The project reuses the existing post structure as the substructure, cladding it with new materials and adding a large arched sign panel across the top. No new footings or permit-required structures are involved — this is a renovation of the existing sign in its current location.

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2. OVERALL DIMENSIONS

Dimension	Measurement	Notes
Total Height (ground to arch peak)	20 ft (6.1 m)	From grade to top of arch curve
Clearance Height (ground to sign bottom)	12 ft (3.66 m)	Minimum clearance for Class A motorhomes
Pillar Height (ground to pillar cap)	12 ft (3.66 m)	Bottom of sign panel rests on pillar caps
Sign Panel Height (bottom to arch peak)	8 ft (2.44 m)	Arched panel from pillar cap to peak
Driveway Opening Width (inside to inside)	16 ft (4.88 m)	Between inner faces of pillar clusters
Overall Width (outside to outside)	22 ft (6.71 m)	Including both pillar clusters
Sign Panel Width	18 ft (5.49 m)	Spans between outer edges of pillar caps

Sign Panel Depth (thickness)	6 in (15 cm)	Double-sided sign face

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3. PILLAR CLUSTER SPECIFICATIONS

Each side of the gateway has a **pillar cluster** consisting of a main pillar and a secondary pillar mounted side by side.

3.1 Main Pillar (x2 — one per side)

Specification	Detail
Finished Outer Dimensions	24 in x 24 in (61 cm x 61 cm) square
Height	12 ft (3.66 m) from grade to cap
Construction Method	Clad over existing timber posts using 2x6 or 2x8 framing to create a box, then sheathed with 3/4-inch exterior-grade plywood or 1x8 tongue-and-groove cedar boards
Inner Substructure	Existing round timber posts (approx. 10-12 in diameter) — retained as structural core
Cladding Material	Option A: 1x8 tongue-and-groove Western Red Cedar boards, vertical orientation. Option B: 3/4-inch exterior-grade MDO (Medium Density Overlay) plywood for smooth painted finish
Base	30 in x 30 in (76 cm x 76 cm) flared base skirt, 18 in tall, built from matching cladding material over 2x6 framing. Creates a visual foundation and hides the existing post base/concrete
Cap	28 in x 28 in (71 cm x 71 cm) pyramid cap, built from 2x material and capped with copper or painted aluminum flashing. Solar light mounted on top center

3.2 Secondary Pillar (x2 — one per side)

Specification	Detail

Finished Outer Dimensions	18 in x 18 in (46 cm x 46 cm) square
Height	10 ft (3.05 m) from grade to cap — shorter than main pillar
Position	Mounted directly adjacent to the main pillar on the outer side, with a 2-inch gap between them
Construction Method	Freestanding built-up box column using 4x4 pressure-treated post as core, clad with matching material
Footing	12 in diameter x 48 in deep sonotube with post anchor bracket (frost depth for Parkland County)
Cap	22 in x 22 in pyramid cap matching main pillar style. Solar light mounted on top center
Purpose	Visual weight, secondary lighting, and structural bracing for the sign panel

3.3 Pillar Cluster Assembly

The main pillar and secondary pillar on each side are connected with a horizontal timber tie at the 8 ft level (hidden behind the cladding) and a diagonal brace from the secondary pillar to the main pillar at the sign panel connection point. This provides lateral stability for the overhead sign panel.

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4. SIGN PANEL SPECIFICATIONS

4.1 Panel Structure

Specification	Detail
Shape	Arched — flat bottom edge, curved top following a gentle arch
Width	18 ft (5.49 m) — spans between outer edges of main pillar caps
Height at Center (peak)	8 ft (2.44 m) from bottom edge to arch peak
Height at Edges (where it meets pillars)	4 ft (1.22 m) — the arch springs from this height

Thickness	6 in (15 cm) — accommodates double-sided sign faces
Frame Construction	Welded steel tube frame (2 in x 3 in x 1/8 in rectangular HSS tube) forming the arch shape and internal grid. This provides rigidity and wind resistance. The steel frame bolts to steel plates lag-bolted into the main pillar cap structure
Sign Face Substrate	3/4-inch MDO (Medium Density Overlay) plywood — both front and back faces. MDO is the industry standard for painted sign faces: smooth, weather-resistant, holds paint beautifully
Edge Banding	1x4 Western Red Cedar trim around the entire arch perimeter, routed with a bullnose profile

4.2 Wind Load Considerations

The sign panel at 20 ft elevation will experience significant wind load. The steel tube frame is critical. Alberta Building Code requires structures to withstand wind loads of approximately 0.5 kPa (10 psf) for this region. The steel frame and bolted connections to the main pillars must be engineered to handle this. **Recommendation:** Have a local structural engineer review the connection detail between the sign panel frame and the pillar tops before construction.

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5. PAINT AND FINISH SPECIFICATIONS

5.1 Color Palette

Element	Color	Paint Code Reference
Pillars — all surfaces	Kokanee Dark Forest Green	Benjamin Moore HC-190 "Tarrytown Green" or Sherwin-Williams SW 6994 "Greenblack"
Sign Panel Face — background	Kokanee Dark Forest Green	Same as pillars

Sign Panel Border Frame	Metallic Gold	Benjamin Moore 2155-30 "Goldsmith" or gold leaf (see Section 5.3)
Text — primary (KOKANEE SPRINGS, RV VILLAGE)	Warm Cream/Gold	Benjamin Moore OC-12 "Muslin" or 23K gold leaf
Text — script (Welcome to Your Happy Place)	Warm Cream/Gold	Same as primary text
Text — amenity line	Warm Cream/Gold	Same as primary text
Silhouette Scene	Metallic Gold	Same as border frame
Pillar Caps	Copper patina or painted to match gold	Copper flashing (will patina naturally) or painted aluminum
Metal Gates	Kokanee Dark Forest Green	Same as pillars, powder-coated

5.2 Paint System (Pillars and Sign Panel)

The following paint system is recommended for maximum durability in Alberta's freeze-thaw climate:

Coat	Product	Notes
Primer	Zinsser Cover Stain oil-based primer	1 coat on all bare wood and MDO surfaces
Body Coat 1	Benjamin Moore Aura Exterior (flat or low-lustre) in Kokanee Green	Full coverage coat
Body Coat 2	Benjamin Moore Aura Exterior (flat or low-lustre) in Kokanee Green	Second full coverage coat
Clear Topcoat	Sikkens Cetol SRD or equivalent UV-resistant clear coat	Applied over sign face only for additional UV and weather protection

Expected Lifespan: 8-12 years before repainting needed, with annual inspection and touch-up.

5.3 Lettering and Graphics Options

Three options are presented in order of cost (low to high) and quality (good to best):

Option A — Painted Lettering (Budget: $800-$1,500)

Lettering is hand-painted or stencil-painted directly onto the MDO sign face using 1-Shot sign enamel paint in gold. A professional sign painter would lay out the lettering using vinyl stencil masks (cut on a plotter from the approved digital artwork) and spray or brush the gold enamel. The silhouette scene would be painted the same way. This is the most traditional and cost-effective approach. Touch-up is easy.

Option B — Vinyl Graphics with Clear Overlaminate (Budget: $1,200-$2,500)

Lettering and the silhouette scene are produced as cut vinyl graphics using 3M Scotchcal 7725 or Oracal 951 premium cast vinyl in metallic gold. Applied directly to the painted MDO surface. A clear UV overlaminate (3M 8519) is applied over the vinyl for additional weather protection. This provides very crisp, consistent lettering and is easier to replace individual elements if damaged. Lifespan: 7-10 years for premium cast vinyl.

Option C — Dimensional Raised Lettering (Budget: $3,000-$6,000)

Letters are CNC-routed from 1.5-inch thick HDU (High Density Urethane) foam board — the industry standard for dimensional sign letters. Each letter is individually shaped, primed, painted gold, and pin-mounted (with stainless steel pins) standing off the sign face by 1 inch. This creates real shadows and a premium 3D effect. The silhouette scene is also CNC-routed from HDU as a single panel and pin-mounted. HDU is lightweight, weather-proof, does not rot, and holds paint extremely well. **This is the recommended option for the premium look shown in the mock-ups.**

5.4 Back Side Lettering

The back side ("See You Soon, Neighbour!" etc.) uses the same lettering method as the front. If using Option C (dimensional), the script lettering for "See You Soon, Neighbour!" can be CNC-routed as connected script from HDU, creating a beautiful flowing dimensional effect.

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6. LIGHTING SPECIFICATIONS

6.1 Solar Pillar Cap Lights (x4 — one per pillar cap)

Specification	Detail

Recommended Product	Classy Caps Prestige Solar Post Cap Light (8x8 size for main pillars, 6x6 for secondary) or equivalent
Light Color	Warm White (2700K-3000K) — creates the amber glow shown in mock-ups
Brightness	Minimum 100 lumens per light
Power	Solar panel integrated into cap, rechargeable battery (NiMH or Li-ion)
Run Time	8-12 hours on full charge
Material	Cast aluminum housing, powder-coated to match pillar color or copper finish
Mounting	Sits on top of pillar cap, secured with construction adhesive and/or screws from underneath

6.2 Optional Uplighting (Sign Face)

For enhanced nighttime visibility, consider adding LED uplights at the pillar cap level aimed upward at the sign face:

Specification	Detail
Recommended Product	WAC Lighting 5021 or similar low-voltage LED landscape uplight
Quantity	4 (two per side — one on each pillar cap, aimed upward)
Light Color	Warm White (2700K)
Brightness	300-500 lumens per fixture
Power	12V low-voltage, powered by a single transformer with photocell (auto on at dusk)
Alternative	Solar-powered LED spotlights (e.g., LITOM or URPOWER solar spotlights) mounted on pillar caps — no wiring needed

7. GATE SPECIFICATIONS

7.1 Existing Gates — Refurbish

Specification	Detail
Current Gates	Metal ranch-style tube gates, approximately 8 ft wide each (two gates, one per side)
Renovation	Sandblast or wire-brush existing rust, apply Rust-Oleum rusty metal primer, then paint with Rust-Oleum protective enamel in Kokanee Dark Forest Green (color-matched)
Hardware	Replace hinges if worn. Use heavy-duty gate hinges (adjustable, bolt-on type)
Latch	Replace with new chain and padlock or spring-loaded gate latch

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8. MATERIALS LIST (BILL OF MATERIALS)

8.1 Lumber and Sheet Goods

Item	Quantity	Size	Notes
Pressure-treated 2x6	40 linear ft	8 ft lengths	Pillar cladding framing
Pressure-treated 2x8	24 linear ft	8 ft lengths	Pillar cap and base framing
Pressure-treated 4x4	2 pcs	12 ft lengths	Secondary pillar cores
1x8 T&G Western Red Cedar	200 board ft	8 ft lengths	Pillar cladding (if using cedar option)
3/4-inch MDO plywood	6 sheets	4x8 ft	Sign panel faces (front and back) and pillar cladding (if using MDO option)

1x4 Western Red Cedar	60 linear ft	8 ft lengths	Sign panel edge trim
2x4 pressure-treated	20 linear ft	8 ft lengths	Miscellaneous blocking and bracing

8.2 Steel

Item	Quantity	Size	Notes
Rectangular HSS tube	80 linear ft	2x3x1/8 in	Sign panel arch frame
Steel plate	4 pcs	8x8x3/8 in	Connection plates — sign frame to pillar tops
Lag bolts	16 pcs	1/2 in x 8 in	Pillar cap to sign frame connections
Carriage bolts	32 pcs	3/8 in x 6 in	Cladding to substructure connections

8.3 Concrete (Secondary Pillars Only)

Item	Quantity	Notes
Sonotube	2 pcs, 12 in dia x 48 in	Secondary pillar footings
Premix concrete	12 bags (30 kg each)	Fill sonotubes
Post anchor brackets	2 pcs	Simpson Strong-Tie ABU44 or equivalent

8.4 Paint and Finish

Item	Quantity	Notes
Zinsser Cover Stain primer	2 gallons	All surfaces

Benjamin Moore Aura Exterior (Kokanee Green)	4 gallons	Pillars and sign panel — 2 coats
1-Shot gold sign enamel (if Option A)	2 quarts	Lettering and graphics
3M Scotchcal metallic gold vinyl (if Option B)	1 roll, 24 in x 50 yd	Lettering and graphics
HDU foam board (if Option C)	2 sheets, 4x8 ft x 1.5 in	Dimensional letters
Sikkens Cetol SRD clear coat	1 gallon	Sign face topcoat
Rust-Oleum rusty metal primer	1 quart	Gates
Rust-Oleum protective enamel (green)	1 quart	Gates

8.5 Lighting

Item	Quantity	Notes
Solar post cap lights (8x8)	2 pcs	Main pillar caps
Solar post cap lights (6x6)	2 pcs	Secondary pillar caps
Solar LED spotlights (optional)	4 pcs	Sign face uplighting

8.6 Hardware and Fasteners

Item	Quantity	Notes
Stainless steel screws (3 in deck screws)	5 lbs	Cladding attachment
Stainless steel screws (1-5/8 in)	2 lbs	Trim and detail work
Construction adhesive (PL Premium)	4 tubes	Cladding seams and cap attachment

Copper flashing (if copper caps)	1 roll, 12 in x 20 ft	Pillar caps
Gate hinges (heavy duty)	4 pcs	If replacing existing
Gate latch/chain	2 sets	If replacing existing

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9. ESTIMATED BUDGET

Category	Option A (Painted)	Option B (Vinyl)	Option C (Dimensional HDU)
Lumber & Sheet Goods	$1,800	$1,800	$1,800
Steel (fabricated frame)	$2,500	$2,500	$2,500
Concrete & Footings	$300	$300	$300
Paint & Finish	$600	$600	$600
Lettering & Graphics	$800-$1,500	$1,200-$2,500	$3,000-$6,000
Lighting	$400	$400	$400
Hardware & Fasteners	$300	$300	$300
Gate Refurbishment	$200	$200	$200
Labour (estimated)	$3,000-$5,000	$3,000-$5,000	$3,000-$5,000
TOTAL ESTIMATED	**$9,900-$12,600**	**$10,300-$13,600**	**$12,400-$17,100**

Note: Labour estimate assumes a skilled carpenter/handyman team (2 people, 3-5 days). Steel frame fabrication may be done by a local welding shop for $1,500-$2,500 of the steel budget. Sign painting (Option A) or vinyl application (Option B) may require a professional sign company.

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10. CONSTRUCTION SEQUENCE

Phase 1: Preparation (Day 1)

1. Remove all existing signage boards, brackets, and hardware from the current timber gateway structure.
2. Inspect existing timber posts for structural integrity — check for rot at the base, insect damage, and overall soundness. If any post is compromised, sister a new pressure-treated post alongside it before cladding.
3. Remove existing "COME AGAIN" and category signs. Remove ATV Operator notices (relocate to a separate post if needed).
4. Clean and prep existing metal gates — wire brush, sand, and prime.

Phase 2: Secondary Pillar Footings (Day 1-2)

1. Mark locations for the two secondary pillars — each positioned on the outer side of the existing main posts, with a 2-inch gap.
2. Dig or auger holes 12 inches diameter x 48 inches deep (below frost line for Parkland County).
3. Set sonotubes, pour concrete, and install post anchor brackets. Level and plumb. Allow 24-48 hours to cure.

Phase 3: Pillar Cladding (Day 2-3)

1. Build the cladding frame around each existing main post: attach 2x6 nailers horizontally at top, middle, and bottom of each post face using lag bolts into the existing timber.
2. Install vertical cladding boards (1x8 T&G cedar) or MDO plywood panels onto the nailer frame, creating the 24x24-inch square pillar appearance.
3. Build the flared base skirt: frame with 2x6, clad with matching material, creating the 30x30-inch base.
4. Build the pillar cap: frame with 2x8, create pyramid shape, install copper flashing or paint to match.
5. Install the secondary pillar: set 4x4 post into anchor bracket, plumb, and brace. Build cladding frame and install cladding to create 18x18-inch square appearance. Build matching base skirt and pyramid cap.
6. Install horizontal timber tie and diagonal brace between main and secondary pillars (hidden behind cladding at 8 ft level).

Phase 4: Sign Panel Frame (Day 3-4)

1. Have the steel arch frame fabricated by a local welding shop per the dimensions in Section 4. The frame should arrive as one piece or two halves that bolt together at the center.
2. With a crew of 3-4 people and/or a small crane or telehandler, lift the steel arch frame into position on top of the pillar caps.
3. Bolt the steel frame to the connection plates that are lag-bolted into the pillar cap structure. Use minimum 1/2-inch lag bolts, 8 inches long, into solid wood.
4. Check level and plumb. Adjust as needed before final tightening.

Phase 5: Sign Panel Faces (Day 4-5)

1. Cut MDO plywood panels to fit the arch frame — this will require multiple panels joined together. Use a jigsaw or router to cut the arch curve following the steel frame.
2. Attach MDO panels to the steel frame using self-tapping screws through the MDO into the steel tubes. Pre-drill to avoid splitting.
3. Install front face panels and back face panels.
4. Install 1x4 cedar edge trim around the entire arch perimeter using stainless steel finish nails and construction adhesive.
5. Fill all screw holes, seams, and joints with exterior wood filler. Sand smooth.

Phase 6: Paint (Day 5-6)

1. Prime all surfaces (pillars, sign panel, trim) with Zinsser Cover Stain.
2. Apply first coat of Kokanee Green (Benjamin Moore Aura Exterior).
3. Apply second coat of Kokanee Green.
4. Paint the gold border frame line on both sign faces using painter's tape for crisp edges.
5. Apply lettering and graphics per chosen option (A, B, or C).
6. Apply clear topcoat (Sikkens Cetol SRD) over sign faces.
7. Paint refurbished gates in matching Kokanee Green.

Phase 7: Lighting and Final Details (Day 6)

1. Install solar post cap lights on all four pillar caps.
2. Install optional solar uplights if desired.
3. Rehang refurbished and painted gates.
4. Touch up any paint damage from construction.

5. Clean up site, remove construction debris.
6. Final inspection — check all connections, verify clearance height (12 ft minimum), verify sign is level and plumb.

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11. MAINTENANCE SCHEDULE

Task	Frequency	Notes
Visual inspection	Annually (spring)	Check for paint peeling, wood damage, loose connections
Touch-up paint	As needed	Spot-prime and repaint any damaged areas
Full repaint	Every 8-12 years	Full sand, prime, and repaint cycle
Solar light battery replacement	Every 2-3 years	Replace rechargeable batteries in cap lights
Vinyl replacement (if Option B)	Every 7-10 years	Remove old vinyl, clean surface, apply new
Gate hardware lubrication	Annually	Grease hinges, check latch operation
Snow/ice clearance check	After heavy snow	Verify no ice buildup on sign face edges

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12. SIGN FACE CONTENT — EXACT TEXT

Front Face (Entering from Highway 31)

Plain Text

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KOKANEE SPRINGS
RV VILLAGE

[Pine Trees — Adirondack Chairs — Campfire Silhouette Scene]

Welcome to Your Happy Place
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Sites | RV Rentals | Cabins | Pub & Grill | Driving Range | Beach
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Back Face (Exiting toward Highway 31)

Plain Text

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See You Soon, Neighbour!

Once a Villager, Always a Villager.

www.KokaneespringsRV.com
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13. IMPORTANT NOTES

1. **No Permit Required:** This project is a renovation/cladding of an existing structure in its existing location. No new structure is being erected closer to the highway. Verify with Parkland County that a development permit is not required for sign face changes on existing structures.
2. **Structural Engineering:** The overhead sign panel at 12-20 ft elevation will experience significant wind loads. It is strongly recommended to have a local structural engineer review the steel frame design and the connection details to the pillar tops before fabrication.
3. **Utility Clearance:** Verify there are no overhead power lines or utility easements in the immediate area of the sign that could be affected by the increased height.
4. **Frost Depth:** Parkland County frost depth is approximately 4 ft (1.2 m). All new footings (secondary pillars) must extend to this depth minimum.
5. **Existing Structure Integrity:** Before cladding, thoroughly inspect the existing timber posts. If any post shows more than 25% cross-section loss due to rot or damage, it should be reinforced or replaced before proceeding.

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14. DIMENSIONED DRAWINGS

14.1 Front Elevation

This drawing shows the sign as viewed from the highway, looking into the park. It details all vertical and horizontal dimensions, including total height, clearance height, and overall width.

14.2 Side Elevation

This drawing shows a cross-section of one pillar cluster and the sign panel, detailing the depth of the pillars, the internal structure (existing post, new 4x4), and the sign panel thickness. It also illustrates the connection method between the sign panel and the pillar tops.

14.3 Plan View (Top-Down)

This drawing shows the sign from a top-down perspective, detailing the layout of the pillar clusters, the driveway opening, and the overhead sign panel. It clarifies the relationship between the main and secondary pillars and the overall footprint of the structure.